

GFOA Distinguished Budget Presentation Award - Working Checklist

FY2027 Tentative Budget | Updated September 13, 2026 | Internal readiness tool - not for publication

43

ITEMS SUPPORTED

1

VERIFICATION ITEM

150

CONTENT POINTS ADDRESSED

Community Priorities & Organizational Challenges20 pts		
What are the major organizational challenges?	DONE	Page 14 separates capacity, coordination, recurring-cost, revenue-risk, and emergency-readiness pressures.
What are the major community challenges?	DONE	Page 14 identifies growth and aging assets, seasonal coastal demand, and housing affordability and access.
How does the budget address those challenges?	DONE	Challenge-to-Result Plan links each pressure to a specific FY2027 response and funding signal.
Are results expected within the budget period?	DONE	Each response includes an expected FY2027 result and a defined review point.

Long-Term Outlook20 pts		
Impact on the long-term fiscal outlook?	DONE	Dedicated Long-Term Outlook chapter with fund forecasts through FY2031.
Impact on reserve levels?	DONE	Fund-balance trends, the informal \$50M emergency objective, and policy status are disclosed.
Deferred expenses or unmet needs?	DONE	Deferral disclosure distinguishes funded work from needs subject to future prioritization.
New long-term spending obligations?	DONE	Recurring staffing, benefits, contracts, and asset-operating commitments are identified.
Prior-year trends and impact?	DONE	Historical results, year-over-year changes, and multi-year forecasts are included.

Personnel Budget15 pts		
How many total staff are budgeted?	DONE	1,515 FTE: 1,508 full-time and 7 part-time, with Board and Constitutional splits.
How did personnel cost change?	DONE	Personnel Ledger compares FY2026 and FY2027 cost by organization.
Where did staffing increase or decrease?	DONE	Net +15 FTE and office-level position changes are identified.
What are the major personnel cost drivers?	DONE	COLA, health-insurance, retirement, and position effects are separated.
Are workload and staffing pressures explained?	DONE	Turnover, hiring need, position justification, overtime, and service capacity are discussed.

Program & Services Budget15 pts		
What are the major programs and services?	DONE	Eight Board-administered program groupings are defined; exclusions are explicit.
What does each program cost?	DONE	Amount, share, and personnel/contractual/operating/capital mix are shown.
Are program-level goals and results included?	DONE	Each program has a purpose, decision signal, and measurable FY2027 targets.
Are programs aligned with priorities and funding?	DONE	Priority, contributing offices, and funding-source descriptions are included.

Budget Process10 pts		
How is the budget developed?	DONE	Process phases explain request development, review, Board direction, hearings, and adoption.
Who is involved?	DONE	OMB, Administration, departments, Constitutional Officers, Board, and public roles are identified.
How are community priorities considered?	DONE	Strategic priorities are linked to request review and the FY2027 challenge-response plan.
When are decisions made?	DONE	Budget calendar and statutory hearing dates are included.
When and how can the public engage?	DONE	Four workshops, outreach channels, comment themes, decision effect, and hearing opportunities are documented.

Value20 pts		
What is the public getting from government?	DONE	Public Value and Program & Service pages connect spending to services, benefits, contributors, and targets.
How much does government cost?	DONE	Budget in Brief, property-tax example, per-dollar allocations, program costs, and department costs are provided.

Revenue Budget20 pts		
How much revenue is anticipated?	DONE	Revenue ledger and six-year trend show FY2027 resources by source.
Are sources diverse?	DONE	Revenue Portfolio identifies the twelve largest sources and concentration.
How much control does the County have?	DONE	Control, reliability, restriction, and trend are classified by major source.
Are revenues restricted for specific purposes?	DONE	Per-source restriction labels and fund context are provided.
How is the burden distributed?	DONE	Resident, visitor, user, business, and intergovernmental shares are explained.

Department Budget15 pts		
What services does each department provide?	DONE	Department profiles identify purpose, primary services, goals, and challenges.
What are the costs for each department?	DONE	Personnel, contractual, operating, and capital composition is shown.
How is each department held accountable?	DONE	Historical measures, FY2027 targets, service-change notes, funding, contracts, and capital are provided.

Capital Budget15 pts		
How is capital spending defined?	DONE	Capital Improvement Plan introduction defines the program and presentation.
What is the level of capital spending?	DONE	\$43.8M funded FY2027 program reconciled to fund-specific ledgers.
How are projects prioritized?	DONE	Prioritization narrative and project decision information are provided.
How is capital funded?	DONE	Funding sources are shown by project and fund; grants and previously funded work are separated.
Is new, replacement, and rehabilitation work distinguished?	DONE	Project purpose and type are identified in the detailed presentation.
Are major projects and FY2027 timing shown?	DONE	Major projects include benefit, phase/timing, FY2027 amount, and future-funding context.

Budget Document - Material Type10 pts		
Is the publication organized with a clear table of contents?	DONE	Three-page contents, chapter dividers, page numbers, and PDF bookmarks are present.
Is the budget message prominent?	DONE	The transmittal letter appears at the front of the publication.
Are graphics and images effective?	DONE	Charts, allocation graphics, project cards, portraits, and visual summaries are used throughout.
Is the document available from the website?	DONE	The site includes an interactive full-budget viewer linked to the current PDF.
Does the PDF meet accessibility standards?	PARTIAL	Tagged PDF and document language are present; complete reading-order, contrast, alt-text, and assistive-technology validation remains.

Current assessment: All substantive content categories are supported. "Done" means the current publication contains responsive content; it does not guarantee an award score. The remaining partial item requires formal accessibility testing beyond the presence of PDF tags and language metadata.